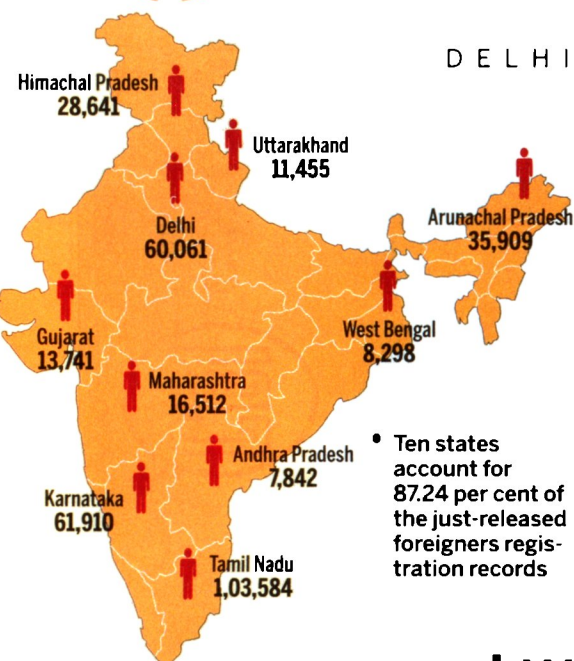




DELHI

I Inflow Counter

The number of foreign visitors continues to increase. According to the 2009-10 Ministry of Home Affairs report, 52,82,603 foreigners visited India during 2008, an increase of 3.64 per cent over 2007. With almost 8 lakh visitors, Americans topped the list of foreigners coming to India, with Tamil Nadu welcoming the largest number to its shores. After the US, the biggest numbers came from the UK, Bangladesh, Canada, Sri Lanka, France, Germany and Australia. Students were the highest percentage of registered foreigners, followed by employees and tourists. The report says that 7,426 foreigners were arrested during 2008 while 13,995 deported. **by Stephen David**

• Ten states account for 87.24 per cent of the just-released foreigners registration records

DELHI

Clean Trip

An air filtering machine established by Italian firm System-life s.r.l. in Connaught Place shows that the PM10 (particulate matter less than 10 micron), is over twice the permissible limit. The EU standard for it is 40 mg/m³, while for India is 100.

Before the system was set up in March, the level of PM10 was 272.6 ug/m³, while PM2.5, smaller sized particles, was 151.4. Post-filtration, it was brought down to 0.1 ug/m³ for both. In 35 days, the machine collected over 20 trillion airborne particles. **by Nandini Vaish**

DELHI

I Wheels of Progress

To showcase e-governance initiatives of the UPA Government, the Department of Information Technology (DIT) has tied-up with the Ministry of Railways to launch an exhibition on a train that will run across the country. With 15 coaches, including six for the DIT and five for the Railways, the train will exhibit initiatives to deliver services like birth and death certificates, land records and agricultural techniques. For maximum visibility, the train will make nearly 40 halts, some to coincide with the passing of the Commonwealth Games baton. The Ministry of Railways has waived off the train's operational costs. **by Nivedita Mukherjee**

A TRAIN SHOWCASING THE UPA'S e-GOVERNANCE INITIATIVES WILL MAKE A FREE ROUND TRIP OF THE COUNTRY.

MODI'S SEVENTH BOOK VENTURE FOCUSES ON 'SOCIAL EQUALITY' AND 'COHESION'.

GUJARAT I Write on Top

The ghosts of the Gujarat riots continue to haunt Chief Minister Narendra Modi, but apparently they haven't been able to scare away the poet in the chief minister. Modi's passion for poetry is well known and so is the fact that his collection of poems titled *Aankh Aa Dhanya Che* (Oh Eye, We Are Thankful to You) was received well by readers three years ago. Last week, Modi's artistic side was at display once again during the release of his seventh book *Samajik Samrasta* (Social Cohesion) that deals with social equality and cohesion, and attacks untouchability and female infanticide. Explaining the difference between social equality and cohesion, Modi said, "If there is a fire on a stage then the actors, part of an assembled entity, would most probably run for their lives but if a fire breaks out in a house, the family members will try to save each other. Our final destination has to be social cohesion." **by Uday Mahurkar**



MODI (SECOND FROM RIGHT) AT THE BOOK RELEASE